

## Diwakar Adhikari

Kathmandu-16, Nepal | +977-984-3247059 | thisisdwakr@gmail.com | Website | Google Scholar

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### Education

**MSc in Environmental Science**, Central Department of Environmental Science (CDES), Tribhuvan University (TU), Nepal, 2021- 2024, **CGPA: 3.85**

**Coursework:** Ecology, Pollution, Environmental Chemistry, Environmental Management, Geology, Climate Change, Water Resource Management, GIS, Environmental Modelling, R and Python

**Specialization:** *Water Resource Management, Restoration Ecology*

**Thesis:** *Assessment of Sediment Load, Transport Mechanisms, and the Impacts Due to Hydropower Plants in the Marsyangdi River Basin.*

**Supervisor:** Deep Narayan Shah, PhD., Assistant Professor, CDES, TU

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**BSc in Environmental Science**, Tri-Chandra Multiple Campus, TU, Nepal, 2015-2018

**Major:** *Environmental Science and Chemistry*, **Elective:** *Zoology*

**Project Work:** *Status of Water Sanitation and Hygiene of Slum Area: A Case of Balkhu, Kathmandu.*

**Advisor:** Kishor Kumar Maharjan, PhD., Assistant Professor, Tri-Chandra Multiple Campus, TU

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### Research Interest

- Integrated and/or Urban Water Systems, Governance and Political Economy
  - Modelling Water Systems for Climate-Resilient Infrastructure and Adaptation
  - Contaminant Fate, Transport, and Treatment
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### Publications

Upadhaya, M., **Adhikari, D.**, Thapa, L. B., Yadav, R. K. P., & Pant, R. R. (2026). Assessment of drinking water quality and irrigation suitability in the Marsyangdi River Basin, Nepal: Implications for SDG 6 and ecosystem sustainability. *Environmental Earth Sciences*, 85(5), 130. [doi.org/10.1007/s12665-025-12782-4](https://doi.org/10.1007/s12665-025-12782-4)

Pant, R. R., Zhang, F., Qaiser, F. U. R., Varol, M., **Adhikari, D.**, Wang, G., Saqr, A. M., & Bishwakarma, K. (2025). Trace elements in fluvial sediments of the Gandaki River Basin, Central Himalaya, Nepal: Distribution, sources, and risk assessment. *Journal of Soils and Sediments*, 25(8), 2463–2480. [doi.org/10.1007/s11368-025-04091-x](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11368-025-04091-x)

Pant, R. R., Koirala, M., **Adhikari, D.**, & Gaire, N. P. (2024). Ecological Restoration in Nepal: A Comprehensive Policy Overview. In Z. Shang, A. A. Degen, D. Gauchan, M. Koirala, & M. K. Rafiq (Eds.), *Sustainable Ecological Restoration and Conservation in the Hindu Kush Himalayan Region* (pp. 149-166). CABI. [doi.org/10.1079/9781800622579.0011](https://doi.org/10.1079/9781800622579.0011)

**Adhikari, D.**, Thapa, L. B., Yadhav, R. K. P., & Pant, R. (**Under Review in Meteorological Applications**). *Hydroclimatic Changes in the Marsyangdi River Basin, Central Himalaya under CMIP6 Scenarios: Implications for the Water–Energy–Food–Ecosystem Nexus.*

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**Adhikari, D., & Baral, S. (Under review in International Journal of Climatology).** *Assessing the Impact of Climate Change Using Multiple Climate Indices at Local Levels of Nepal: Implications for Local Adaptation Planning and Water Resource Management*

Adhikari, D. (2025, June 26). *The majestic Upper Mustang and its water troubles. The Farsight Nepal.* <https://farsightnepal.com/news/the-majestic-upper-mustang-and-its-water-troubles/>

Adhikari, D. (2026, June 4). *Seasons of uncertainty: The quiet reshaping of lives across Nepal.* The Farsight Nepal. <https://farsightnepal.com/news/seasons-of-uncertainty-the-quiet-reshaping-of-lives-across-nepal/>

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## **Research Experience**

**Independent Projects**, Aug 2025 – Apr 2026

### **Projects:**

1. *Hydroclimatic Changes in the Marsyangdi River Basin, Central Himalaya under CMIP6 Scenarios: Implications for the Water–Energy–Food–Ecosystem Nexus* | [GitHub link \(Codes\)](#)
2. *Assessing the Impact of Climate Change Using Multiple Climate Indices at Local Levels of Nepal: Implications for Local Adaptation Planning and Water Resource Management*

**Research Fellow**, Department of Botany, Tribhuvan University, Oct 2023 – Sept 2024

**Project:** *Water-soil-food nexus and Sustainable Livelihoods Through the Mainstreaming of Agrobiodiversity Along the Marsyangdi River Basin, Gandaki Province, Nepal*

**Research Assistant**, Research Center for Applied Science and Technology, Sept 2023 – Apr 2024

**Project:** *Assessment of Environmental Pollution at Sisdol Landfill Site*

**Research Assistant**, Kathmandu University, Jun - Jul 2022

**Project:** *Spring Water Assessment in Karnali River Basin*

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## **Conference Presentations**

Pradhananga, N., Nathaniel, A., Shrestha, A., \***Adhikari, D.**, Karmacharya A., *Nepal Waste Map*, 4th ISWA-YPG online conference, 2021

\***Adhikari, D.**, Pradhananga, P. & Karmacharya, A. (2021). *Establishing a community-driven governance system through Digital Waste Management System.* Society of Environmental Engineers of Nepal, Ecocity Satellite Conference, 2021.

\**Presenting author*

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## **Scholarships/Grants/Awards**

Research Fellowship, Department of Botany, **Tribhuvan University**, Oct 2023

Data Fellowship, **Code for Nepal**, Jul 2023

Most Innovative Development Project (Runner up), **Global Development Network**, Dec 2021

Climate Action Fund, **The Asia Foundation**, Dec 2021

Digital Solution Systems for Province 2, **The Asia Foundation**, Sept 2021

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### **Technical Skills**

**Hydrologic modeling:** SWAT+, HEC-HMS, watershed delineation and calibration

**GIS & Remote Sensing:** QGIS, ArcGIS; geospatial data collection and mapping

**Programming & Data:** Python; statistics and visualization; Excel; basic scientific computing

**Climate & Hydrology:** GCM selection, climate impacts assessment

**Field & Lab:** water/soil/sediment/leachate sampling, QA/QC, lab analysis

**Qualitative:** Focus Group Facilitation, Semi-structured Interviews & Key Informant Surveys, Thematic Coding & Content Analysis, Policy & Institutional Mapping, Stakeholder Engagement & Knowledge Co-production, Narrative & Case Study Development

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### **Professional Experience**

**Program Coordinator**, Nepal Peacebuilding Initiative, Jul 2024 - Jun 2025

**Project:** *Strengthening Policy-level and Grassroot Capacity to Enhance Climate Change Adaptation for Marginalized Communities*

**Consultant**, People in Need Nepal, May – Jun 2023

**Project:** *Urban Resilience Project in Balaju and Godavari*

**Program Officer**, CLEAN UP NEPAL, Dec 2018- Feb 2022

*Various Projects and Programs related to Integrated Waste Management, Circular Economy, Environmental Governance, WASH, Air Pollution*

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### **Other Activities**

- Member of Youth for Water and Environmental Partners (YoWEP) since June 2026
  - Member of UNESCO Ecohydrology Youth Network (EHYN) since October 2025
  - Member of International Water Association – Water Professional Group, Nepal Chapter since 2024
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### **Language Proficiency**

**English Language Proficiency:** C1 (IELTS 8.0 overall, British Council)

**German Language Proficiency:** A2 (Duolingo)

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### **References**

1. Deep Narayan Shah | Assistant Professor | CDES | Tribhuvan University  
Email: dnshah@cdes.edu.np
  2. Ramesh Raj Pant | Assistant Professor | CDES | Tribhuvan University  
Email: rpant@cdes.edu.np
  3. Uddab Raj Khadka | Professor and Head of Department | CDES | Tribhuvan University  
Email: ukhadka@cdes.edu.np
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